

Mental Health Clinical Trials, 2010–2025

14,713 interventional trials across 8 condition groups · Source: ClinicalTrials.gov (downloaded 1 October 2026)

Condition group

All

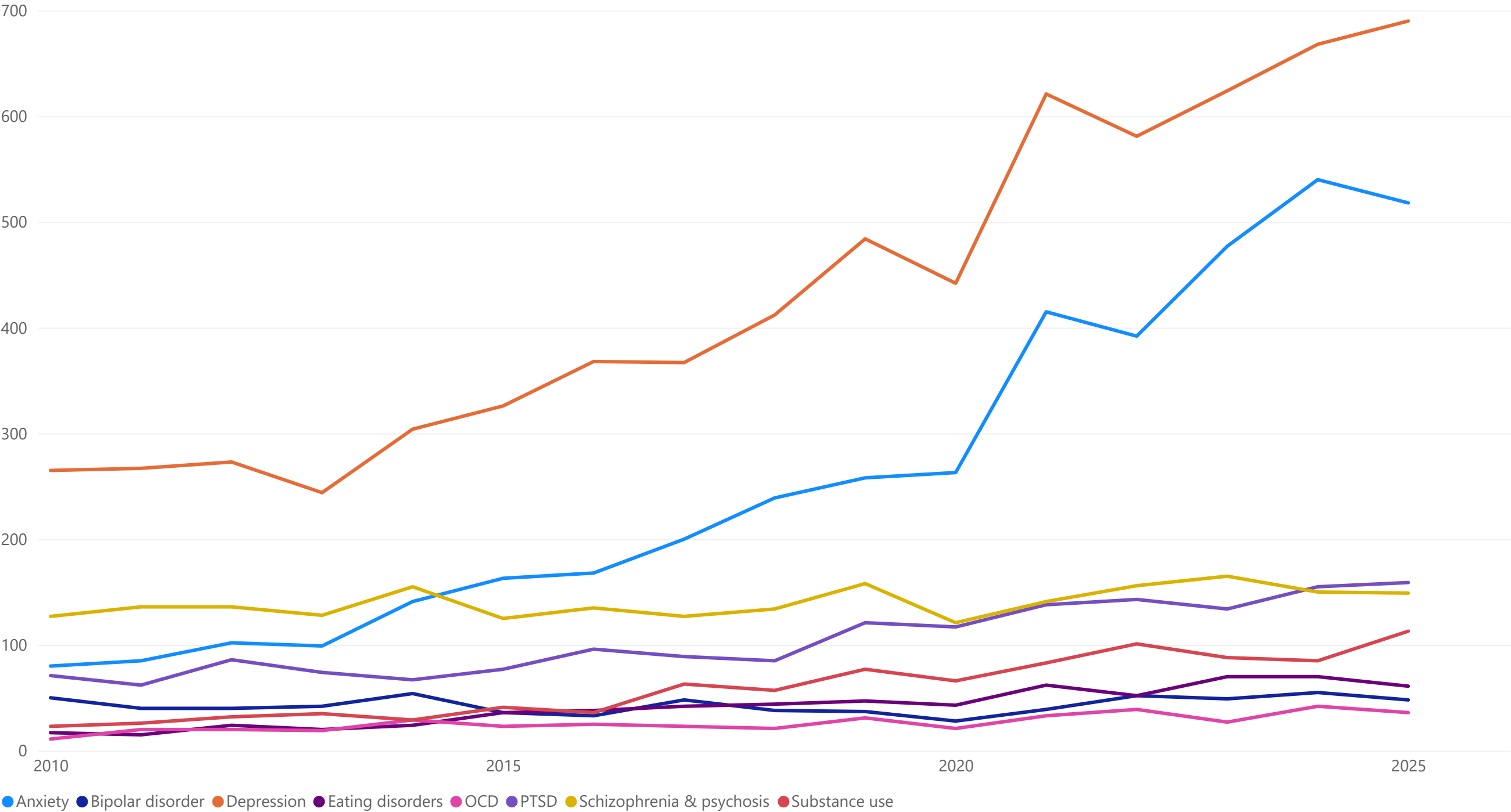
Trials
14,713

Led by universities and hospitals
83.2%

Psychedelic/MDMA trials
165

Include a Canadian site
6.9%

Trials started per year, by condition



Key findings

- Anxiety trials increased 5.7× between 2010–12 and 2023–25, compared with only 1.2× for schizophrenia and bipolar disorder
- Eating disorders (3.6×), substance use (3.5×) and depression (2.5×) also outpaced serious mental illness
- 2020 saw fewer new trials in 7 of 8 condition groups, followed by more in all 8 the next year
- Universities and hospitals lead 83% of trials
- Use the condition filter (top right) to focus every page on one condition

Treatments

Drug, behavioural and device trials, and psychedelic research since 2010

Condition group

All

Psychedelic/MDMA trials

165

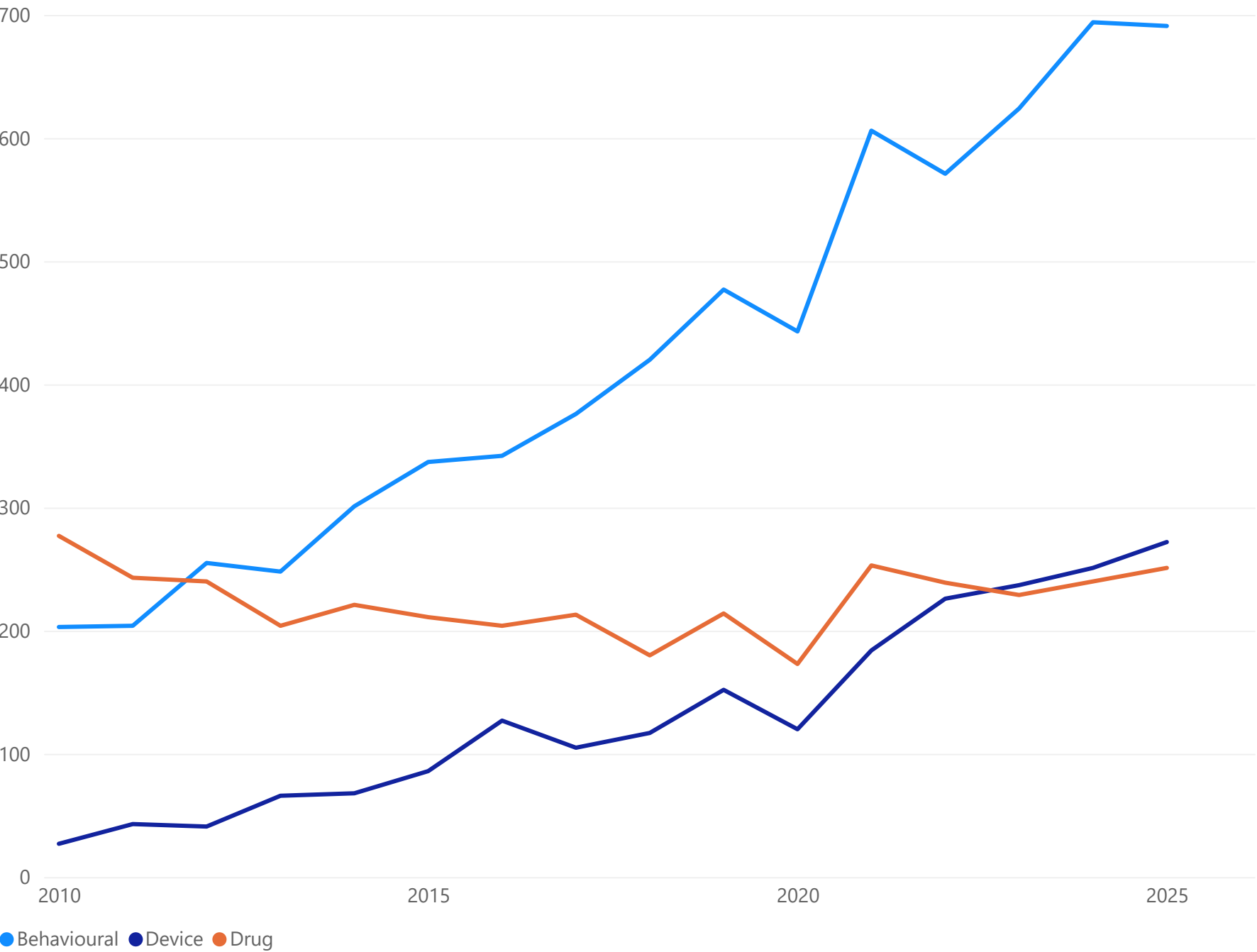
Ketamine/esketamine trials

318

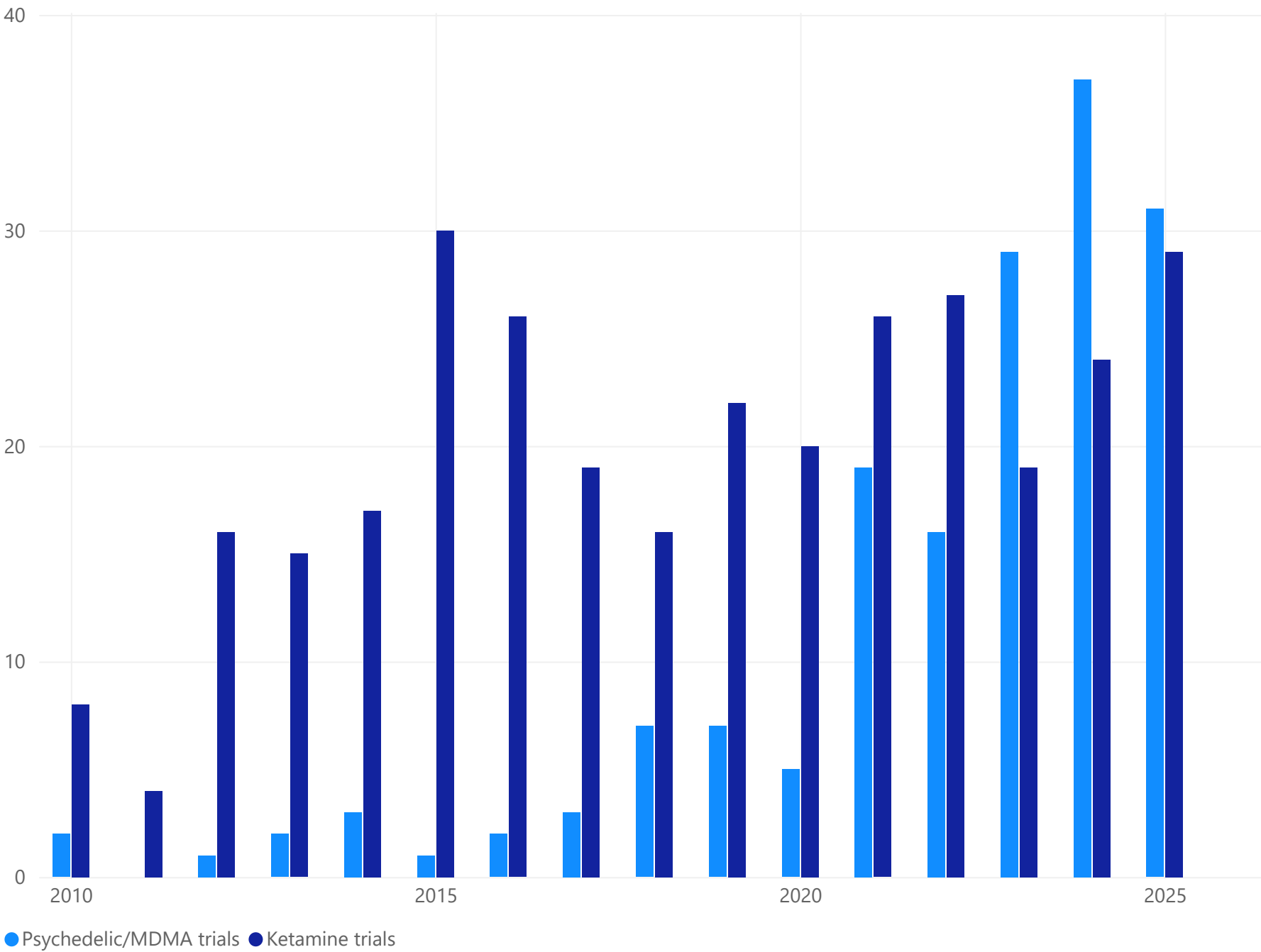
Key findings

- Drug trials held roughly level (277 in 2010, 251 in 2025) while behavioral trials increased 3.4× and device trials 10×, driven by brain stimulation and virtual reality
- 80% of psychedelic trials started in 2021 or later; they have outnumbered ketamine trials since 2023
- Placebo, control and "Other" interventions are left out of the treatment chart

Trials per year by treatment type



Psychedelic vs ketamine trials per year



Sponsors & outcomes

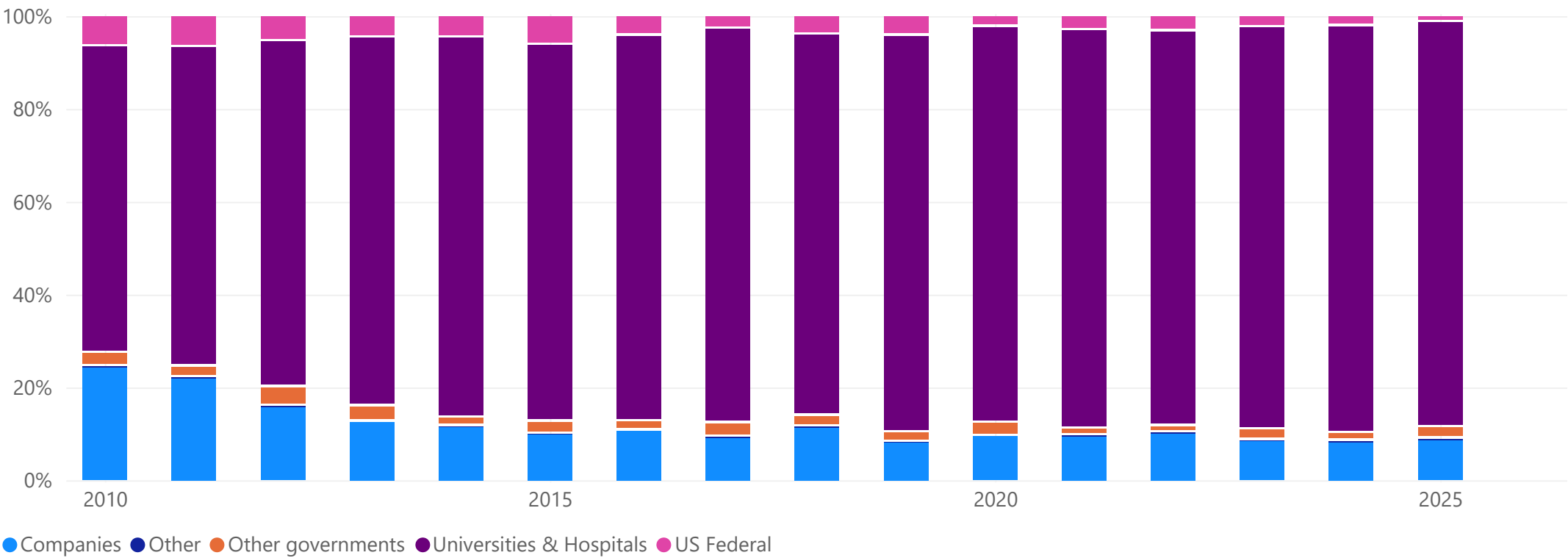
Who leads mental health trials, and why some stop early

Condition group

All

▼

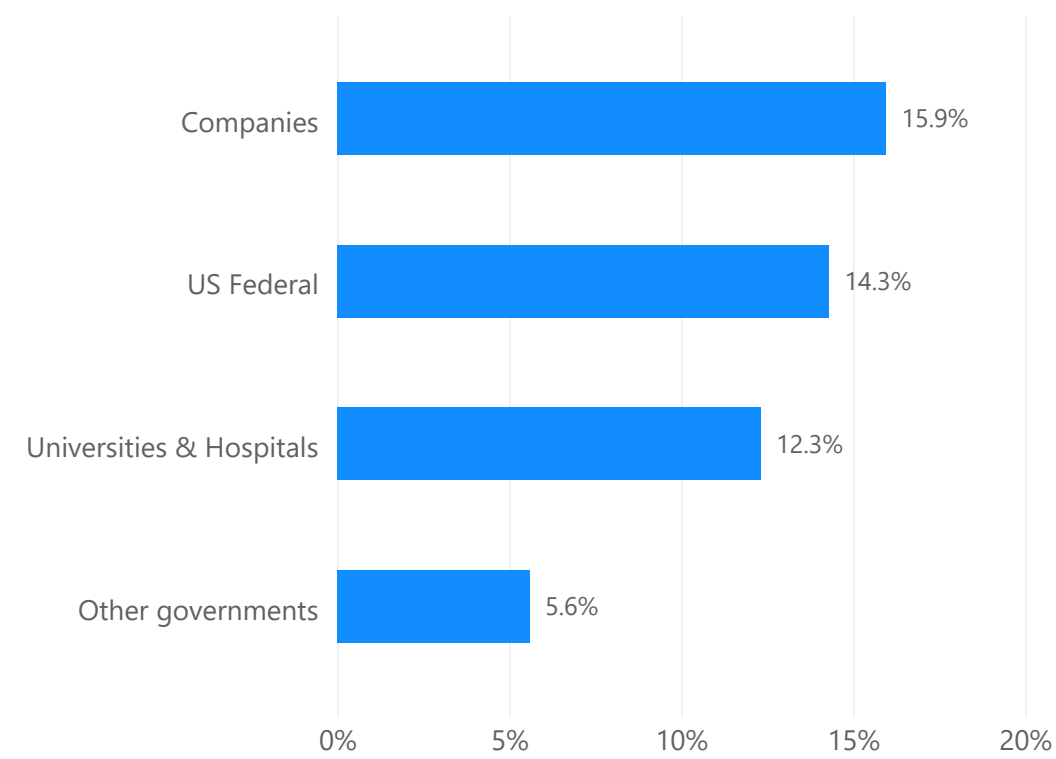
Who leads the trials? Share by sponsor type



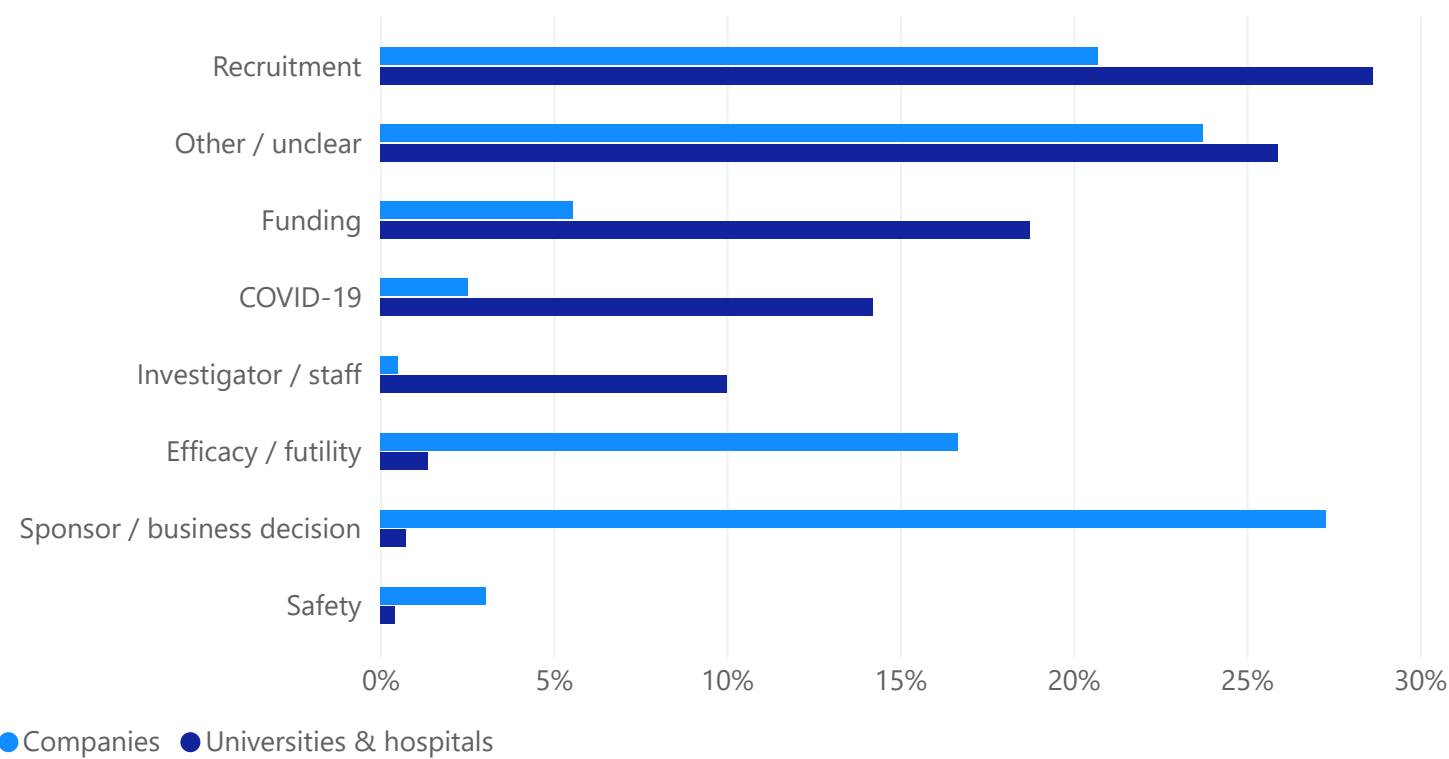
Top 10 lead sponsors

Sponsor	Type	Trials
VA Office of Research and Development	US Federal	306
Massachusetts General Hospital	Universities & Hospitals	212
Yale University	Universities & Hospitals	140
Centre for Addiction and Mental Health	Universities & Hospitals	133
Stanford University	Universities & Hospitals	133
University of California, Los Angeles	Universities & Hospitals	130
Shanghai Mental Health Center	Universities & Hospitals	116
New York State Psychiatric Institute	Universities & Hospitals	115
Karolinska Institutet	Universities & Hospitals	110
University of California, San Francisco	Universities & Hospitals	103

Share of ended trials that stopped early



Why trials stop (stated reasons, all conditions)



Key findings

- Universities and hospitals lead 87% of 2025 trials, up from 66% in 2010; company-led trials halved by 2015, then recovered to near their 2010 level
- Company trials stop early more often (15.9% vs 12.3%), mostly for business reasons or lack of efficacy; academic trials stop for recruitment, funding and COVID-19
- Safety was the stated reason in under 1% of stopped trials
- Reasons for stopping trials come from a saved SQL result, so that chart does not respond to the condition filter

Canada

Trials with at least one site in Canada

Condition group

All

▼

Trials with a Canadian site

1,020

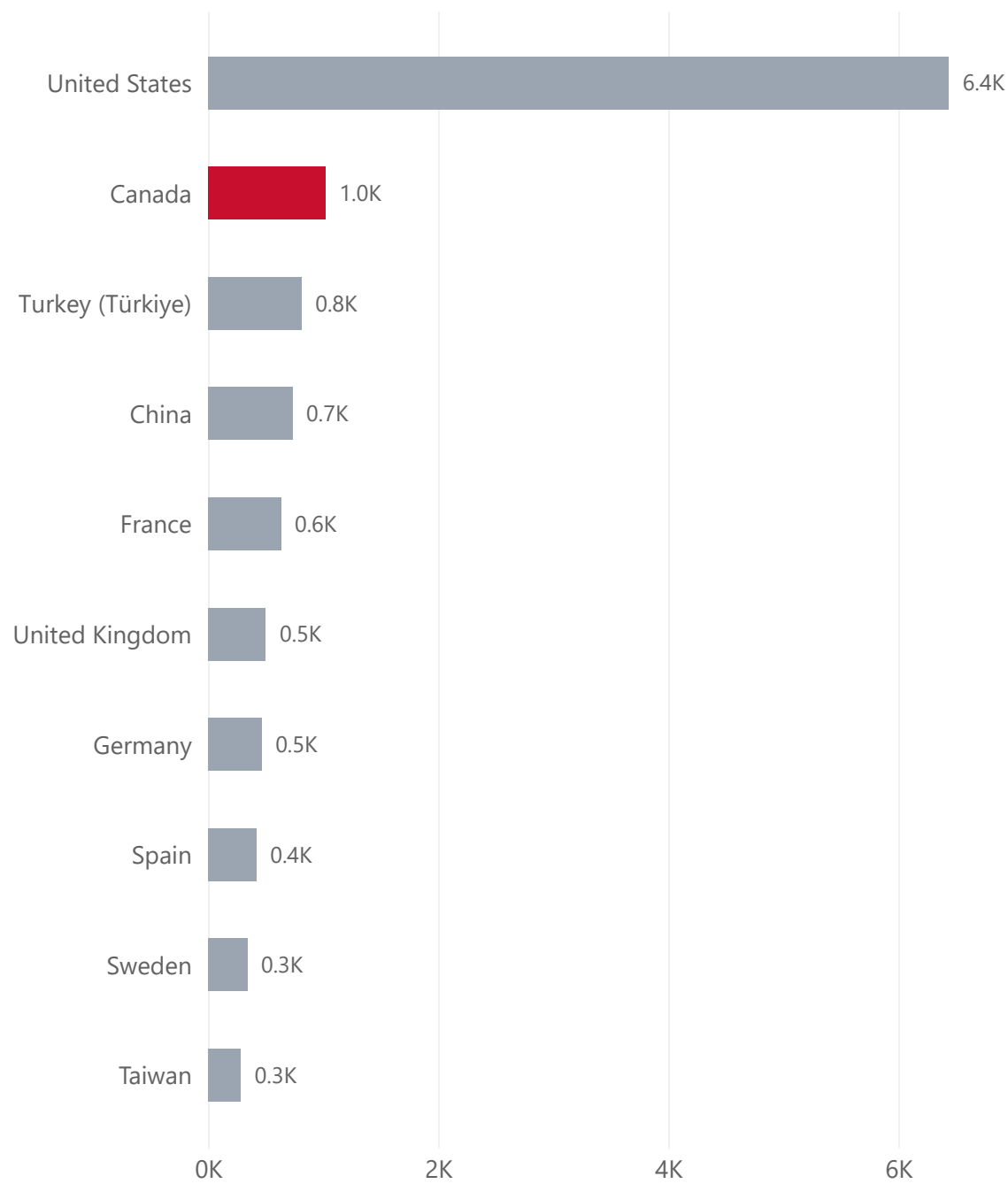
Share of all trials

6.9%

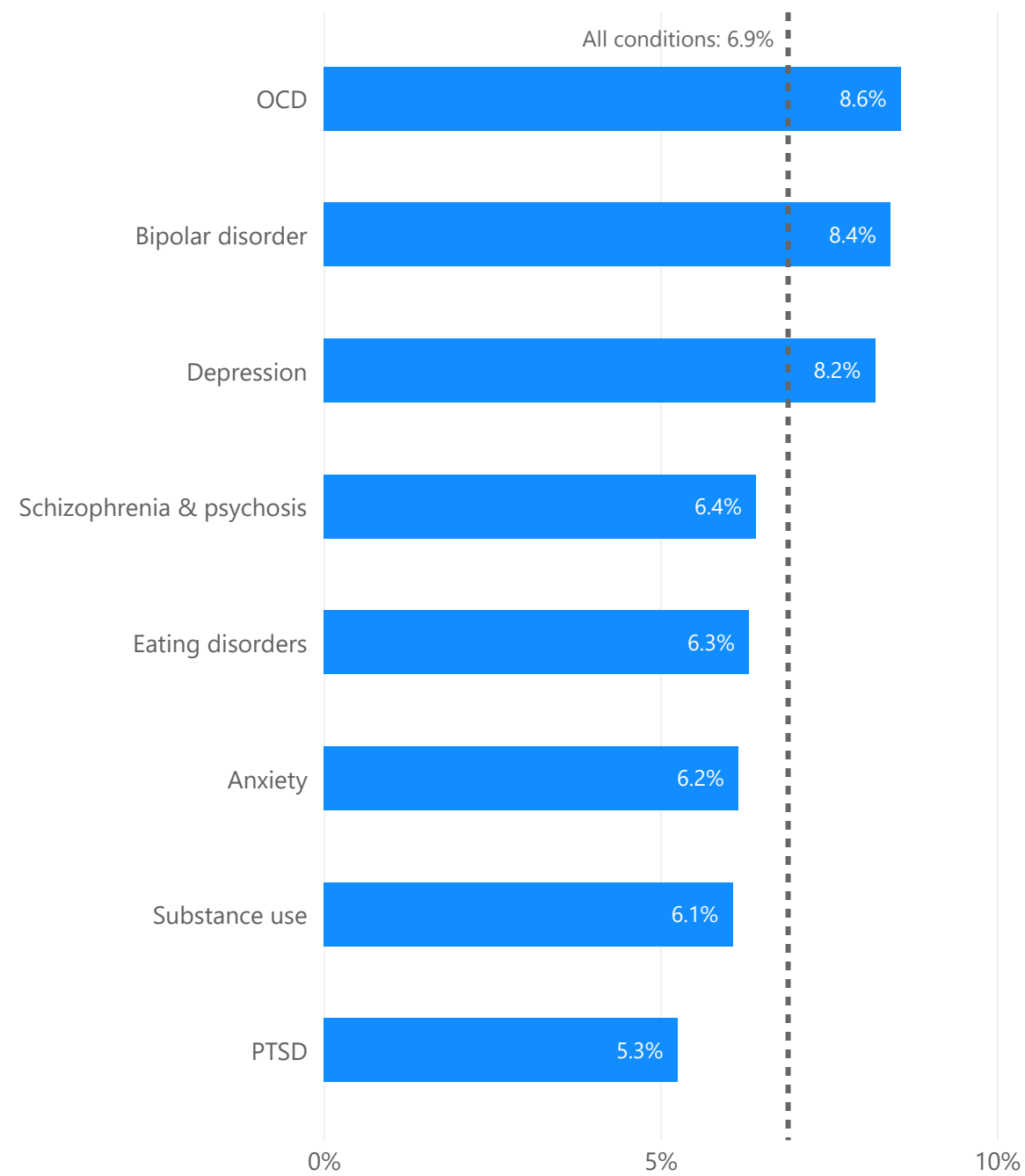
Key findings

- Canada ranks #2 after the US: 1,020 trials (6.9%) include a Canadian site, about 25 trials per million people vs 19 in the US
- Canada's share is highest in OCD, bipolar disorder and depression, and lowest in PTSD, where the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs sponsors more trials than any other organization
- ClinicalTrials.gov is US-based, so many European and Asian trials register elsewhere

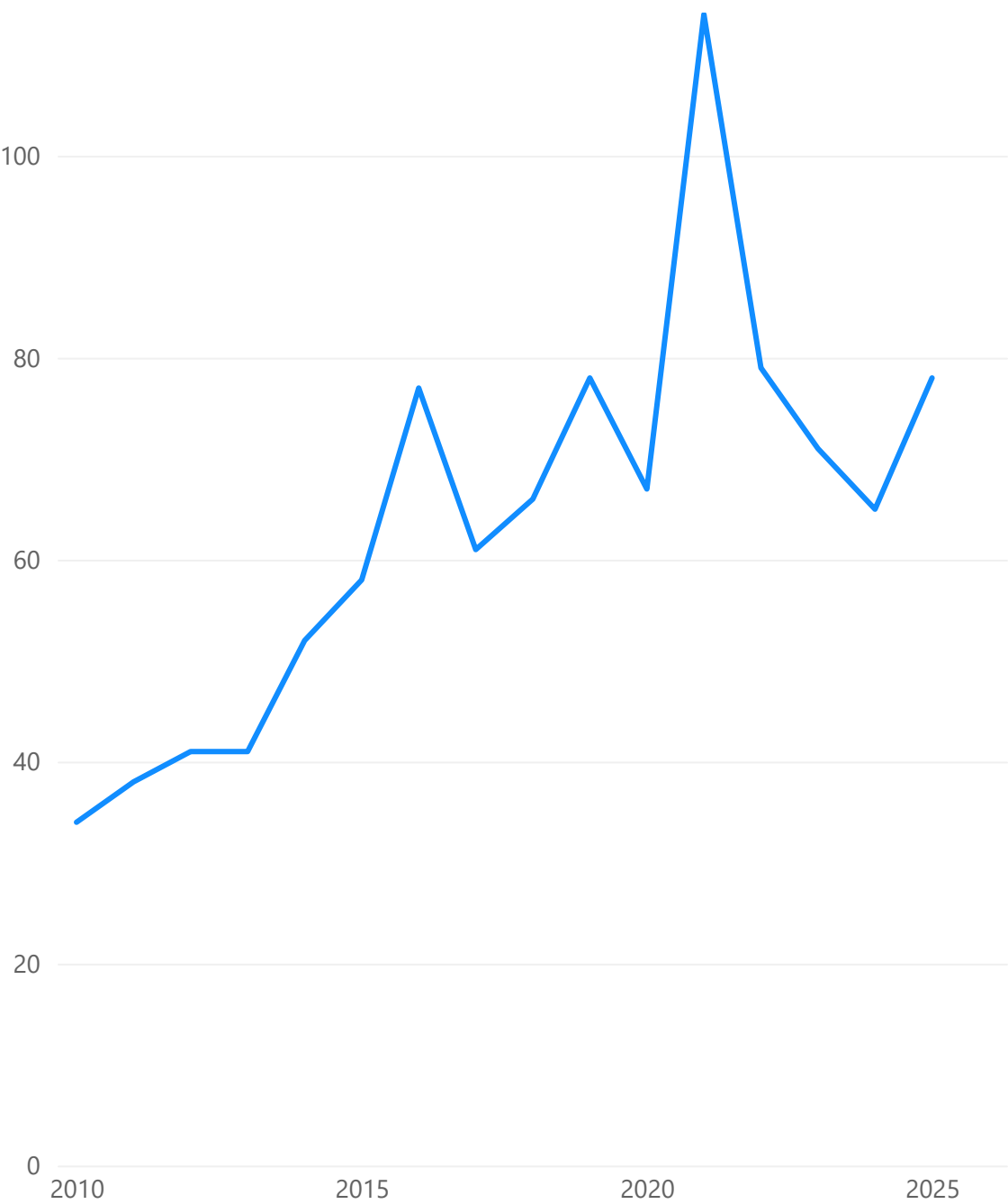
Top 10 countries by trials with a site there



Share of trials with a Canadian site, by condition



Trials with a Canadian site, per year



Methods & caveats

How the data was collected, grouped and checked

Data

Source: ClinicalTrials.gov API v2 (U.S. National Library of Medicine), downloaded 1 October 2026.

Interventional trials that started 2010–2025: 18,357 downloaded; 14,713 list at least one of the eight condition groups and are analysed here.

Pipeline: Python (API download and cleaning) → SQLite (SQL analysis) → Power BI. Code and queries: github.com/mgoldenitz/mental-health-trials-pipeline

Validation

Checked against ClinicalTrials.gov website searches: schizophrenia in 2020 matched exactly (121 vs 121); PTSD in 2022 within 4% (143 vs 149). For eating disorders in 2024, a trial-by-trial comparison showed the website's extra results were obesity and diet studies, and that no eating disorder trials were missing.

How trials are grouped

Conditions: Free-text conditions grouped into eight DSM-5-aligned groups with keyword rules; non-psychiatric uses (e.g. surgical anxiety, respiratory depression) are excluded. A trial can belong to several groups.

Treatments: ClinicalTrials.gov intervention types (Drug, Behavioural, Device); "Other" is mostly placebo and control groups and is excluded from treatment charts.

Psychedelic flag: Substance names plus company drug codes (e.g. COMP360, MM-120); ketamine/esketamine flagged separately because both are already approved.

Sponsor type: Lead sponsor only. "Companies" = industry; "US Federal" includes the VA and NIH.

Caveats

- ClinicalTrials.gov is US-based; many European and Asian trials register elsewhere, so country rankings reflect this registry.
- Registrations increased over the period, so comparisons between groups are more reliable than raw growth.
- Stop-reason chart uses grouped free text (1,212 stopped trials with a reason) and does not respond to the condition filter.
- Counts reflect registrations, not research funding or trial size.